

in both industry and academia. Based on the available data, it is reasonable to expect that some of these languages will remain permanent fixtures in the Top 10, while the others are likely to hold stable positions within the Top 20.

Julia presents a less straightforward case. It appears only once in the Top 20, and that too at the 20th position in the PYPL ranking. It does not appear in the RedMonk Top 20 list, ranks 31st in the IEEE Spectrum ranking, and 28th in the TIOBE index. Despite this modest showing, Julia is still a relatively young language, with its first release in 2012. Given its strengths in scientific and high-performance computing, there remains reason for optimism, and it deserves to be retained among the promising programming languages to watch in 2026.

Solidity, the programming language I added in 2021 to the 2019 list of seven promising languages, entered the discussion at a time when blockchain technology was at the peak of its popularity. Designed for implementing smart contracts on blockchain platforms, Solidity was widely viewed as a potential breakout language. However, its recent performance suggests that it may not become the next major force in the programming world after all. As blockchain technology has moved beyond its hype phase into a more mature phase, expectations surrounding Solidity have also become more grounded. With a 25th rank in the IEEE Spectrum ranking and a 41st rank in the TIOBE index, Solidity no longer appears to be an imminent breakout star, particularly given its domain-specific nature. Reluctantly, I therefore retract my earlier prediction and remove Solidity from the list of promising programming languages.

But should we include any new language in our list of promising contenders? I must admit I hesitated, especially after having to retract my earlier optimism about Solidity. However, after careful research, I have

decided to add one more language to the list: Zig, a systems programming language designed as a modern, general-purpose improvement over C. Zig is free and open source software released under the MIT License. Since it was first released in 2016, it is still very much in its formative years.

How does Zig perform in the rankings we have considered? It is currently placed at the 24th position in the PYPL ranking and appears within the top 100 of the TIOBE index. While these positions do not yet signal dominance, they indicate steady visibility and growing interest. That alone is encouraging enough to justify watching Zig closely. I plan to revise this list in a couple of years, and it will



Figure 2: The logo of Zig

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be interesting to see how far Zig has progressed

by then. Figure

With Zig's inclusion, the final list of promising programming languages now consists of Swift, TypeScript, Go, Rust, Kotlin, Dart, Julia, and Zig.

What the Stack Overflow 2025 Developer Survey says

Now let us look at some insights from the Stack Overflow 2025 Developer Survey, one of the most comprehensive global surveys on programming and developer trends. After the United States and Germany, India ranks third in the number of respondents, highlighting the country's growing technology adoption and expanding developer community.

Some results from the survey help explain Rust's first-time entry into the Top 10 list. The survey distinguishes between desired and admired languages, and Rust ranks as the most admired

programming language at 72%. Now consider Cargo, Rust's build system and package manager -- according to the survey, Cargo is the most admired cloud development and infrastructure tool in 2025. The survey also highlights the popularity of uv, an extremely fast Python package and project manager written in Rust, further reflecting Rust's growing influence in modern programming.

The survey also supports my decision to include Zig in the list of promising programming languages. Zig records a strong admiration score of 64%, making it the fourth most admired programming language. Perhaps this time the prediction will hold more firmly than my earlier optimism about Solidity. The survey also reinforces Python's global dominance.

I hope this analysis proves useful to students of computer science as well as working professionals, since understanding programming language rankings can help you evaluate whether your current area of expertise remains relevant and which languages may be worth learning next. At the same time, we must ask a deeper question: will programming look the same a decade from now, given the rapid rise of advanced AI tools? Could we enter a phase where many traditional programming roles are replaced by prompt engineering? It is a possibility — but it is equally certain that programming itself will not disappear. The tools may evolve, but skilled programmers will continue to shape how technology is built and used.

With that thought, I bid you farewell until we meet again to discuss the next wave of trends in the programming world in a few years' time. **END** 🐧

By: Dr Deepu Benson

The author is a free software enthusiast, and his area of interest is theoretical computer science. He is an assistant professor (senior scale) at Manipal Institute of Technology, Bengaluru, and maintains a technical blog.